

What can be done online without getting into a legal trap?

Ask yourself - “what can be done offline (in real world, not on the Internet) to live a normal life without inviting into legal troubles?” The answer is obvious - you have to do your everyday job, live normally and make sure that you are not supporting any activity which causes disturbance to the harmony of society. Now, as complex as it gets with the Indian constitution, there are multiple laws protecting and governing any activity. Laws for online behaviour are not an exception either. No matter how confusing the pages of law become, there are simple ways to express it. If you are going to get involved into something heated and/or controversial concerning a topic which can be sensitive from any perspective (concerning topics that are religious, political, racist) then please go through the rule-books first. Except under some conditions, the following simple list should be sufficient to help you about what you can do online.

1. You may share your thoughts with the others. There is no harm in saying what you want to say as long as it is not about hurting a man's sentiments, or the man himself!
2. You can share pictures and videos with others because pictures and videos are means of communication of thought.

Just two points in the ‘dos’ list? Well, yes, because almost all others can be covered in the list of what not to do. After all, a lot of labour goes in the making of our online life; a lot of activities happen and we have got used-to a lot of stuff in a way that it is better to tell what not to do than about what to do.

What not to do online

Before we start talking about what not to do online, it is important to go back to the basics and remember that online laws more or less just define about what online activities would correspond to what real-world activities. Most of the “how much should the punishment be” part is handled by the traditional law. But once again, it is not required to go through a long manual unless needed. For our day-to-day life, the following list of suggestions should help you get along the electronic tides safe enough.

Don't get harsh

Always behave with-respect to people you know as well as to those whom you do not know. Slander will land you into trouble. At present, we live in a